

Pro Bono Inquiry Email — Baker & McKenzie (Tokyo)

Purpose: First-touch inquiry to Baker & McKenzie's Tokyo office about **pro bono legal support** for the Mitsue Project's 一般社団法人 formation and renewable-energy / community-development legal work.

How to approach Baker & McKenzie

Baker & McKenzie runs a firm-wide **pro bono and CSR programme** aligned with the UN Global Compact and the SDGs, including a dedicated Japan pro bono practice that builds "legal resources for non-profits, public policy institutions and international NGOs." A 一般社団法人 pursuing a renewable-energy and rural-revitalization project is a strong fit for that profile.

Practical realities to keep in mind:

1. **Tokyo office only.** They have no Kansai/Osaka office. Pro bono support would be remote; local Nara/御杖村 administrative filings may still need a Kansai-based 司法書士 / 行政書士 alongside. Frame the ask around the work where a global firm adds most value (structure, contracts, grant/financing terms, governance), not routine local filings.
2. **No public pro bono application form.** The intake route is the general inquiry form; a **warm introduction is far stronger** than a cold one. If any advisor (e.g. Joi Ito) has a contact at the firm, use it.
3. **Be specific and modest in the first ask.** Name a small, well-defined scope (e.g. review of the 一般社団法人 定款 / governance, or one financing/PPA structuring question) — not "represent us." Pro bono teams are capacity-limited and respond best to a clear, bounded request.
4. **Lead with mission fit.** Non-profit + environment + SDG-aligned + open-source/open-data. Make the public-benefit nature unmistakable in the first lines.

How to find the right contact

- Primary route: the firm's **inquiry form** (<https://www.bakermckenzie.co.jp/en/contactus>) referencing pro bono / CSR.
- Stronger route: a **named contact via warm introduction** (ask advisors first).
- Avoid cold LinkedIn outreach to partners for first contact.

What to expect

- A reply may take **2-4 weeks**; pro bono intake is often slower than commercial intake.
- A positive first reply is likely a short acknowledgement and a request for more detail or a brief call.
- Do **not** attach the full documentation set first. If they ask, send the **English + Japanese Introduction A4** only.

Draft Email — 日本語版

To: Baker & McKenzie お問い合わせフォーム (<https://www.bakermckenzie.co.jp/en/contactus>) — または温かいご紹介で得た担当者宛 **Subject:** プロボノ・ご支援のご相談 — 御杖村の地域再生プロジェクト（一般社団法人設立準備中）

ベーカー&マッケンジー法律事務所 プロボノ・CSRご担当者様

突然のご連絡を失礼いたします。オランダ出身で、2012年より奈良県御杖村に在住しております、Rob Oudendijk（ロブ・アウデンダイク）と申します。現在、御杖村において、森林再生・再生可能エネルギー・小規模AIデータセンターを一体とした地域再生プロジェクトを準備しており、その運営主体として**一般社団法人**の設立を進めております。

貴事務所がSDGsおよびプロボノ活動を通じて、非営利団体やNGOの法的基盤づくりをご支援されていることを拝見し、本プロジェクトの公益性についてご相談させていただきたく、ご連絡を差し上げました。

プロジェクトの概要（簡略）：

- 奈良県御杖村の体験交流館を活用した、小規模AI／エッジコンピューティング・データセンター
- 杉間伐材を燃料とする木質バイオマス熱電併給（CHP）を主軸とし、太陽光・EV充電を組み合わせた地産地消型エネルギー
- 25年スケールの森林再生と林業再活性化を併せて推進
- 御杖村が環境省補助で策定した公式の再エネ導入最大化計画（2025年）と整合し、その実行を担う位置づけ
- 環境・エネルギー・林業データをオープンに公開する、地域所有・オープンソース型の運営

現在は第0段階（地域との対話・法人設立準備）にあり、特に以下の点についてプロボノでのご助言を賜れないか、ご検討いただけますと幸いです。

- 一般社団法人の定款・ガバナンス設計に関するレビュー
- 各種補助金・出資を組み合わせた資金調達スキームの法的論点
- 将来的な電力供給（PPA等）・施設利用に関する契約面の留意点

まずは**30分程度のオンライン面談**にて、本プロジェクトの公益性と、貴事務所のプロボノ方針との適合性についてお話しさせていただければ誠に幸甚に存じます。御杖村に近い案件には別途、地元の司法書士・行政書士とも連携する想定でありますので、貴事務所には特にご知見が活きる領域についてご相談できればと考えております。

ご多忙のところ恐縮ではございますが、ご一考いただけますと幸いです。何卒よろしくお願い申し上げます。

Rob Oudendijk（ロブ・アウデンダイク） 御杖プロジェクト 創設者 YR-Design 代表 / Safecast コア・コントリビューター Email: oudendijk.biz@gmail.com / Tel: 080-2260-5966 Project: <https://mitsue.it>

Draft Email — English version

To: Baker & McKenzie inquiry form (<https://www.bakermckenzie.co.jp/en/contactus>), or a named contact if obtained **Subject:** Pro bono inquiry — rural revitalization non-profit (一般社団法人) in Mitsue Village, Nara

Dear Baker & McKenzie Pro Bono / CSR Team,

My name is Rob Oudendijk, a Dutch national resident in Mitsue Village (御杖村), Nara Prefecture since 2012. I am preparing a rural revitalization project that integrates forest restoration, renewable energy, and a small-scale AI data center, and I am in the process of establishing a 一般社団法人 (**general incorporated association**) as its operating entity.

Having seen that your firm supports non-profits and NGOs through its SDG-aligned pro bono and CSR programme, I am writing to ask whether the public-benefit nature of this project might make it a candidate for pro bono assistance.

Project at a glance:

- Small AI / edge-compute data center in the Mitsue Taiken Koryukan (a community exchange center), Mitsue Village, Nara
- Energy led by **biomass CHP from cedar (sugi) forest thinnings** (heat + power), complemented by solar PV and EV charging — a local, circular energy economy
- Paired with a 25-year forest restoration and forestry revitalization programme
- Aligned with Mitsue Village's official MoE-funded Renewable Energy Plan (2025); the project is positioned as its implementation vehicle
- Community-owned, open-source operating model with open publication of environmental, energy, and forestry data

The project is currently in Phase 0 (community consultation and entity formation). The areas where your firm's expertise would be especially valuable include:

- Review of the 一般社団法人 articles (定款) and governance design
- Legal questions around a financing structure stacking multiple grants and impact investment
- Contractual considerations for future local power supply (e.g. PPA) and facility use

If you would be open to it, I would welcome a **brief 30-minute introductory call** to discuss the project's public-benefit profile and whether it fits your pro bono priorities. For matters close to Mitsue we plan to work alongside a local 司法書士 / 行政書士, so we would focus any request to your firm on the areas where its expertise adds the most value.

I am grateful for any consideration you can give, and I fully understand if pro bono capacity is limited.

With sincere thanks,

Rob Oudendijk Founder, Mitsue Project Founder, YR-Design · Core Contributor, Safecast Email: oudendijk.biz@gmail.com · Tel: 080-2260-5966 Project: <https://mitsue.it>

Notes for sending

- **Send Japanese first.** Paste the Japanese block into the inquiry form; English below it or omit on first send.
- **Subject:** Japanese subject preferred; if a short field, use 「プロボノ・ご支援のご相談 — 御杖村プロジェクト」.
- **Attachments:** None on first contact. If asked, send only the EN + JP Introduction A4.
- **Scope discipline:** Keep the first ask bounded (定款 review / one financing question). Do not request full representation up front.
- **Don't lead with** funding totals, the gap figure, or commercial-sounding asks — frame as public-benefit / mission fit.
- **Follow-up:** If no reply in ~21 days, one short polite follow-up, then leave it.
- **Warm intro:** Before sending cold, check whether Joi Ito or another advisor has a Baker & McKenzie contact — it materially improves the odds.